

Chaldale Harbor District

Meeting date	Public Port Authority And Marina Operator Tuesday, 12 November 2024, 6:00 p.m. 1400 Tidewater Way, Chaldale, WA 98554
Location	Commission Chambers, 1400 Tidewater Way, Chaldale, WA (360) 355-0142
Meeting type	Regular meeting (Minute type: REGULAR; public)
Presiding	Arlene Whitlock, President
Present	Whitlock, Barmore, Nystrom, Pell (Laskin absent -- excused)
Staff present	R. Calloway, G. Fjell, L. Brasher, M. Tenny, D. Ivers

1. Call to Order; Roll Call

President Whitlock called the meeting to order at 6:00 p.m. The Clerk called the roll; Commissioner Laskin was excused. Four commissioners present; quorum confirmed.

2. Agenda; Minutes

The agenda was approved 4-0 on motion by Commissioner Nystrom. The minutes of 8 October 2024 were approved 4-0 on motion by Commissioner Pell.

3. Public Comment

Two speakers. Ms. Sandra Milovich asked about wait times for 32-foot covered slips; the President noted the annual waiting-list report. Mr. Patrick Dunn complained about gate lighting at Eastwey; the Harbormaster took the item for the maintenance log.

4. 2024 Rate Study -- Presentation

Finance Manager Brasher presented the 2024 moorage rate study, comparing covered and open rate classes on the foot-month basis and modeling revenue at current occupancy of 96.8 percent. The study recommends holding rates flat for 2025 and revisiting the covered/open differential after the state performance audit now being scheduled is complete. Commissioners asked about the aging of receivables; Ms. Brasher reported 4.1 percent of billed moorage over 90 days. No action taken; the study will return with the 2025 budget.

Commissioner Pell asked whether the study accounts for the difference between posted slip length and measured vessel length in the foot-month charge. Ms. Brasher answered that the charge uses the greater of the two, per the tariff, and that the study's revenue model uses the billed lengths in the billing system rather than the posted lengths. Commissioner Barmore asked about the electricity recovery line; Ms. Brasher said recoveries run about 96 percent of cost and that the difference is immaterial.

Commissioner Nystrom asked that the study workbook be made available to commissioners with the budget materials, including the scenario comparison sheet and the foot-month verification sheet. Ms. Brasher agreed.

5. Annual Waiting-List Report

Administrative Services Manager Merithew presented the annual report: 2,874 applicants on the list as of 31 October 2024, median wait for a covered slip estimated at 11.2 years, 336 offers and 94 skips logged year to date. She noted the confirmation mailing for 2024 will go out 2 December. Commissioner Barmore asked that future reports break skips out by the four Schedule C reason codes.

At Commissioner Barmore's request, Ms. Merithew gave the year-to-date skip breakdown from the register: vessel-fit 36, not-current 27, declined-prior-offer 14, preference-mismatch 17. She noted the pattern is stable year over year and reflects an aging list: many high-ranked applicants recorded preferences years ago that no longer match their current vessels or intentions. Commissioner Nystrom asked whether the confirmation mailing could invite preference updates; Ms. Merithew answered that the 2024 mailing already includes a preference block and that counter staff key amendments the day they are received.

Commissioner Pell asked about the vessel-fit skips: whether the District ever re-measures an applicant's vessel before skipping. Ms. Merithew answered that the skip rests on the particulars of record, that applicants are told they may request a dock measurement, and that since Resolution 2022-06 a length amendment must be supported by a measurement certificate or a haul-out record before the amended length is used.

5-A. Budget Schedule for 2025

Finance Manager Brasher laid out the 2025 budget calendar: department requests to the finance committee by 10 December 2024; committee recommendation at the January meeting; public hearing and adoption at the February meeting. She flagged two known requests above the line: the Salmonberry float replacement (grant-dependent) and the information systems change request CR-0412 for user-identifier logging on the legacy amendment screen, open since 2021 and estimated at \$38,400. President Whitlock asked that CR-0412 be presented with the migration options analysis from the deferral record so the Commission can see the whole decision rather than the line item.

6. Harbor Operations -- Winter Readiness

Deputy Harbormaster Fjell reported completion of the fall inspection of Vessbank and the open basins, replacement of 11 pedestal breakers, and storm protocols for the season. She reported that as-built measurements taken during the Vessbank inspection agree with the posted dimensions within tolerance on all rows except Row F, where two 32-foot slips measured 31.6 feet and will be reposted at 30 feet pending float work. No action taken.

7. Consent Agenda

Items 7.1 (October voucher register, \$389,114.72), 7.2 (September financial statement), and 7.3 (surplus disposal of the retired work skiff) were approved on a single motion by Commissioner Pell, seconded by Commissioner Barmore. Motion carried 4-0.

8. Correspondence

The Clerk summarized correspondence: three waiting-list inquiries, one request for an itemized billing explanation on the foot-month basis (answered by the billing office with a worked example), and one complaint regarding a derelict vessel at Salmonberry (referred to the Harbormaster under the seizure policy).

8-B. Voucher Detail for the Month

For the record, the October voucher register of \$389,114.72 comprises 201 vouchers: moorage refunds and adjustments \$4,987.10; utilities and electricity \$84,115.62; maintenance and supplies \$88,402.33 (including the eleven Vessbank pedestal breakers); payroll and benefits \$196,811.44; professional services \$14,798.23. Commissioner Pell asked whether the breaker purchase was capital or expense; Ms. Brasher answered expense, under the small-equipment threshold.

8-A. December Workshop Announcement

President Whitlock announced a workshop session for the December meeting on waiting-list communication, continuing the series begun in 2022: the confirmation mailing's preference block, the counter's explanation of the four Schedule C reason codes, and the letter applicants receive when a skip affects them. Commissioner Nystrom asked that the counter's telephone offer script be included on the workshop agenda; the Harbormaster agreed and noted the script was last revised in March 2024.

9. Committee Reports; Commissioner Comments

Commissioner Barmore reported on the finance committee's review of the receivables aging and recommended no change to the late-fee schedule. Commissioner Nystrom asked that the 2025 training calendar include a refresher on the four Schedule C reason codes for all counter staff. President Whitlock reported on the tidelands lease negotiation.

10. State Performance Audit -- Advance Notice

Harbormaster Calloway informed the Commission that the District has received advance notice of a state performance audit expected to begin fieldwork in January 2025, covering slip assignment order, length-amendment support, and skip file documentation. He asked Ms. Merithew to serve as audit liaison and asked staff to prepare the export files the engagement letter lists: the applicant register, offer events, skip events, the amendment log, billing, and the slip inventory. Commissioner Barmore asked that the Commission receive monthly status reports during fieldwork; the President so ordered.

11. Adjournment

The meeting adjourned at 7:41 p.m. on motion by Commissioner Barmore, seconded by Commissioner Nystrom, carried 4-0.

Minutes submitted by: Dolores Ivers, District Clerk / Commission Secretary

Approved: Arlene Whitlock, President (approved 10 December 2024)